AEROFORGE

ELITE CARBON · FORGED FOR YOU

Business Simulation — Our Story

Marketplace® Conscious Capitalism · Bikes · July 2026

“We lost the race — and built the machine that would win the next one.”

Aaron Rainier President · Luna Carballo Marketing · Justine Pellier Analytics · Patrick Yang Finance · Sarah Baraket Sales · Teysnim Abichou HR

Strategy & ambition

Mission — Elite carbon performance within everyone's reach — creating value for riders, employees, communities and the planet we ride through.

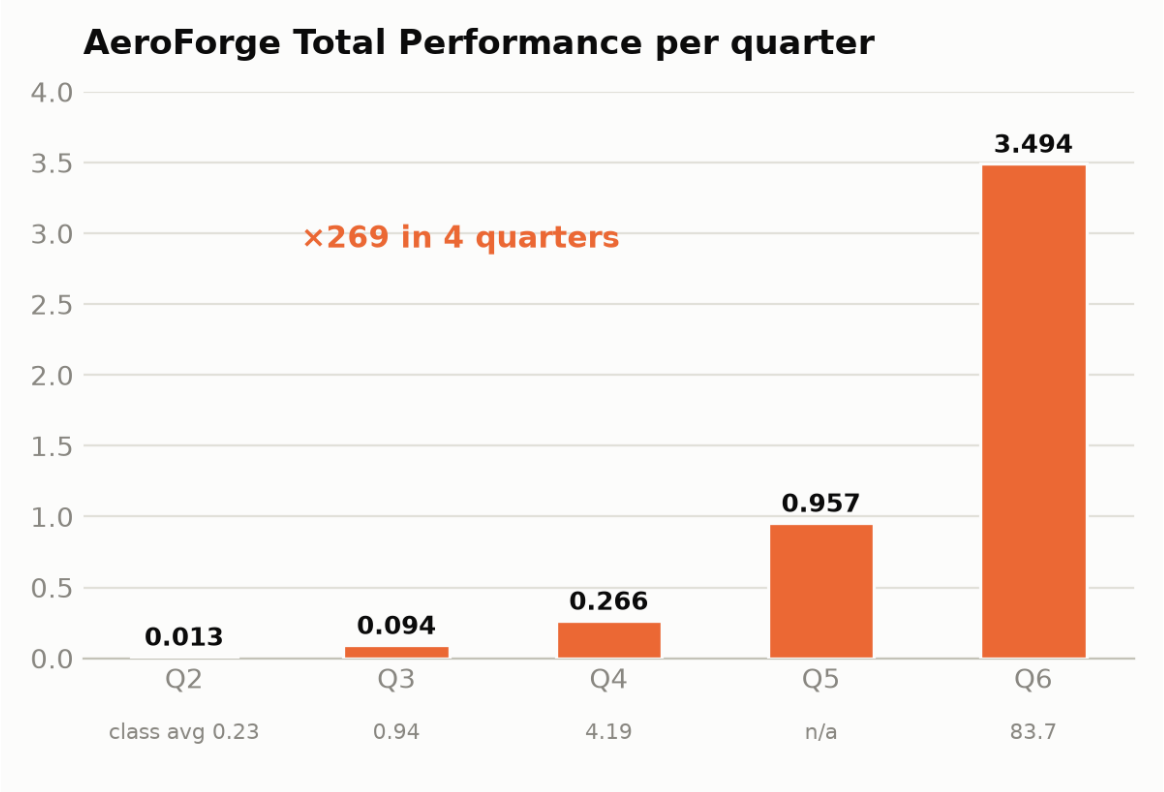
Targets & positioning — Primary: Mountain · Secondary: Speed. Premium, value-driven, conscious-capitalism positioning — win on product quality, never on price.

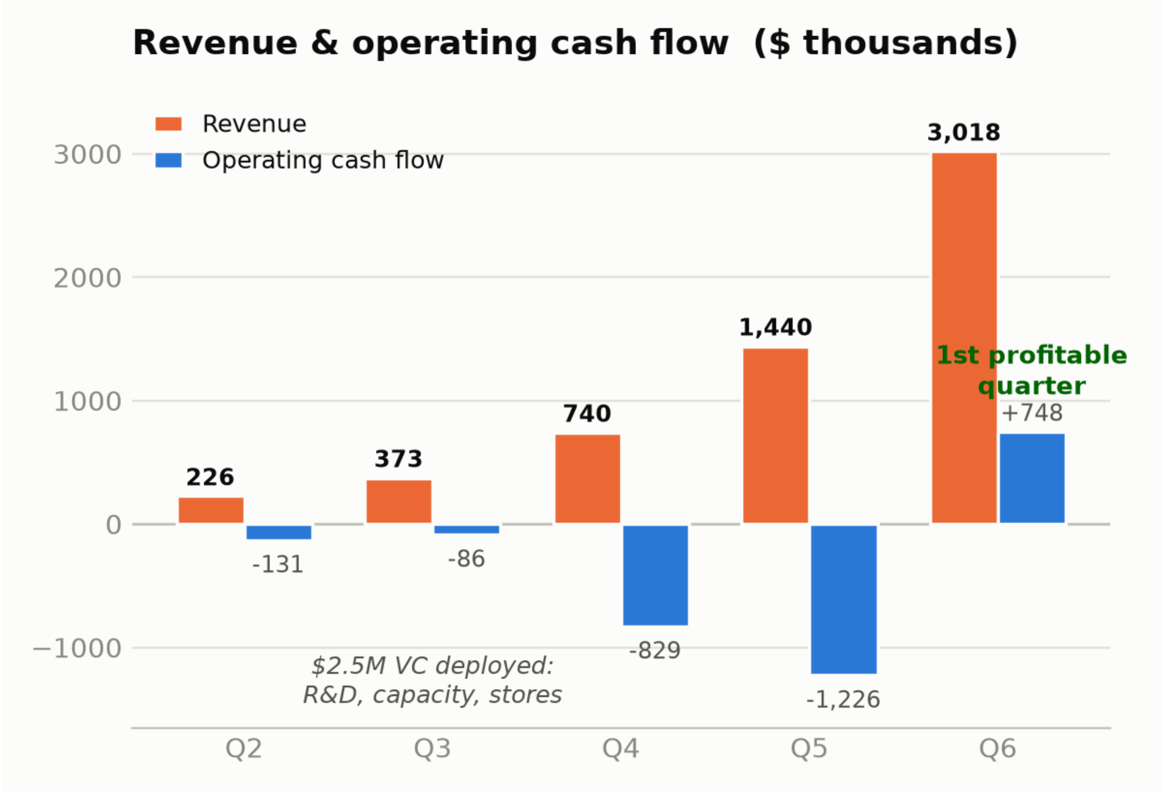
Footprint — New York City → Amsterdam (Q4, the game's largest market) → Bangalore (Q5). Funded by a $2.5M venture round backed by our business plan.

Organization — A real executive committee: 6 VPs with clear ownership. Every decision argued with data; the President arbitrates.

WHAT HAPPENED

Key results — the honest version





Cumulative scorecard: last (0.70 vs class avg 14.9). A cumulative index never forgives a failed test market — our Q2 hole followed us to the end.

Q6 finale: 2,235 bikes sold · $3.0M revenue · net income +$708k · demand (3,318) outgrew even our doubled factory.

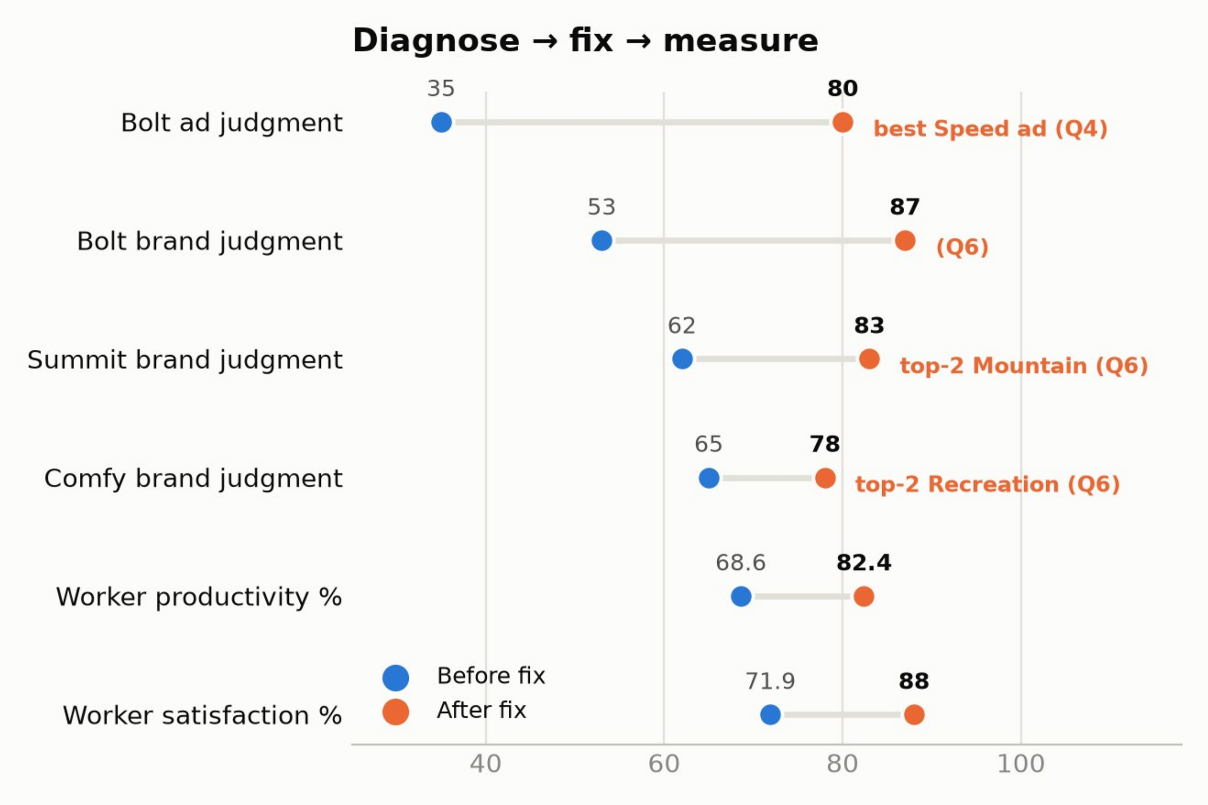
Conscious scorecard: only firm never cited for toxic leaks · employee satisfaction 88% · turnover 32%→11%.

One failure, one success, one new method

Failure — designed by intuition — Q2 test market: a Speed ad built on Mountain claims (35/100) and “comfort” parts on a mountain bike (62 < the 70 recommendation threshold). Demand starved for two quarters.

Success — designed from data — From Q3: copy the revealed component matrices and leader ad structures — then enriched carbon across the range. By Q6: Bolt 53→87, Summit 62→83, Comfy 65→78. Every product top-tier.

The method change, mid-week — Buy every study, justify every field with a number, verify every save — Check Ad Claims · Final Check · pro forma last.



WHAT WE LEARNED

Three lessons we'll keep

1 · Business disciplines are one system — A 35/100 ad starves a factory; below-market pay cut productivity to 68.6% and helped cap our factory — 88 sales lost to stock-outs in Q4. We never lost money “in finance” — we lost it in marketing and HR first.

2 · Under time pressure, intuition is a hypothesis — not a decision — The test market exists to buy data before you bet. The ~$45k of studies we skipped in Q2 cost us two quarters of momentum.

3 · Play the scorecard like an engineer — Learn how each metric is computed, then work backwards. The ones winnable from day 1, we won: #1 in class on Investment in Future and Financial Risk. The cumulative one punishes early mistakes forever.

+ People tell you first — In-basket memos about sick workers → clean-room investment → morale up, satisfaction 88%. Listen to the weak signals.

If we started over

Top recommendation — Spend your first dollar on information: buy every market study in Q2 and design from the component matrices — never from instinct. One failed quarter costs 50× the studies.

One thing we'd never do again — Ship anything unbenchmarked — an ad, a salary, a price. The market had already published the right answer; we just hadn't bought it.

AeroForge exits Q6: 100% enriched-carbon range · first profitable quarter (net +$708k) · $2.06M cash, zero debt · #1 in class on cumulative Investment in Future & Financial Risk

Our question for you: *your scorecard is cumulative too — which “Q2 mistake” are you still paying for, and have you actually diagnosed it?*